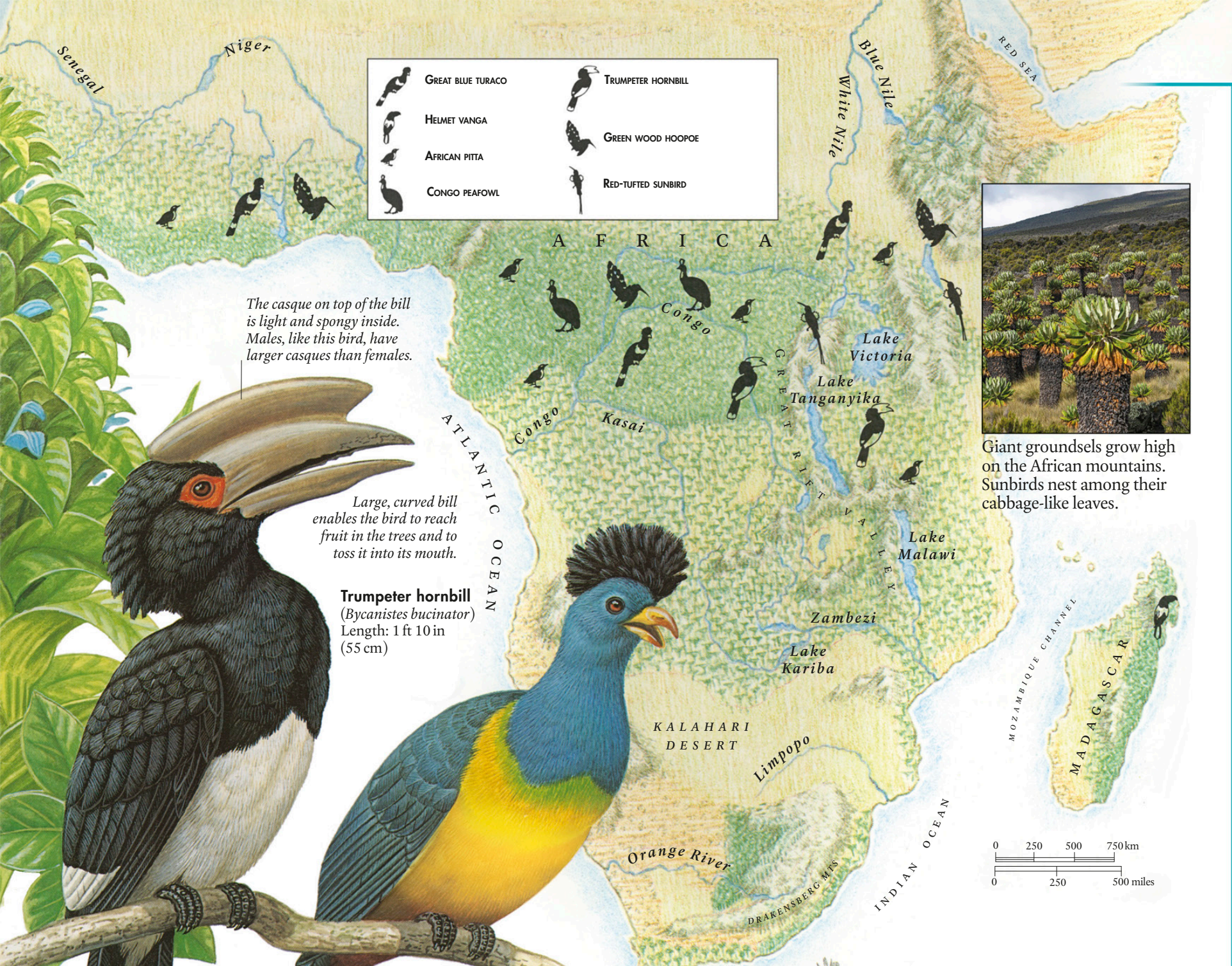




The casque on top of the bill is light and spongy inside. Males, like this bird, have larger casques than females.

Large, curved bill enables the bird to reach fruit in the trees and to toss it into its mouth.

Trumpeter hornbill
(*Bycanistes bucinator*)
Length: 1 ft 10 in (55 cm)

Great blue turaco
(*Corythaes cristata*)
Length: 2 ft 6½ in (75 cm)

Great blue turaco

Groups of up to 12 great blue turacos run and climb through the treetops. They feed on fruits, including berries that are poisonous to humans. The nest is a flimsy platform of twigs built in a tall tree. When very young, chicks scramble around the nest using tiny claws on their wings to keep their balance. After about four weeks, they leave the nest for good.

Only males have this tuft of white bristles.

African pitta
(*Pitta angolensis*)
Length: 8 in (20 cm)

African pitta

The shy African pitta hops through dense undergrowth on the rainforest floor searching for slugs and insects. Although it is brightly colored, it blends in surprisingly well with the leafy forest background. To threaten enemies, it crouches down with its wings spread and its bill pointing upward.

Congo peafowl

This unusual bird is the only true African pheasant—all the others originally came from Asia. Unlike other pheasants, such as the common peafowl (peacock), the Congo peafowl has a short tail. It lives on the rainforest floor, feeding on fruits and insects.

Both males and females have bright, shiny feathers.

Congo peafowl
(*Afropavo congensis*)
Length: 2 ft 3 in (70 cm)

Trumpeter hornbill

The loud, wailing call of the trumpeter hornbill sounds like a child crying. Most hornbills have very unusual nesting habits. A pair build a nest inside a hole in a tree then seal the opening, leaving the female inside. The male passes food to her through a narrow slit. This temporary prison protects her and her chicks from predators.